

Flashing the ROM

Now that we are all done with backups and are able to successfully boot into the customised recovery manager, all we need to do is find and download our much-wanted ROM, and flash it with the help of the ClockWorkMod Recovery menu. To do this, we need to boot into the *recovery* mode, wipe all partitions and then choose the 'Install from zip' option. However, if you are using the ROM Manager, it will probably make the job much easier for you by automating the whole process. Note that you should read the instructions that the developer might have given for a specific ROM, since it often happens that the requirements and process might change for some heavily customised ROMs. The best place to find a custom ROM would be <http://forum.xda-developers.com>, a forum where most developers of the Android community lurk. After you have finished flashing your ROM and successfully booted into it, you might also want to install the Google apps, including the Android Market, as most developers do not bundle these due to licensing restrictions.

CyanogenMod: Features and more

CyanogenMod is easily one of the most popular ROMs available for most Android phones, and that is why it deserves a special mention here. It is very popular because of the wide variety of devices that it supports, and also some of the innovative features that it has, such as:

- **Apps2SD:** CyanogenMod and most other ROMs support installing apps to the SD card by default, even if the app itself does not support the feature. This allows you to save a lot of space in case you are installing some heavy software like games, etc.
- **Gestures:** It supports gestures in locked-screen mode, in the music player, etc, so that you can just use hand gestures in order to command the phone to perform an action.
- **Improved permissions:** This allows you to easily control exactly what permissions are available to each application and revoke any permissions if not needed.
- **Phone goggles:** Another innovative feature, which 'filters out' unwanted communications at a specific time,

etc. There are a variety of settings available for such purposes.

- **OpenVPN:** It allows you to set up a VPN to tunnel all your IP and network data.
- **Incognito mode:** It resembles the incognito mode that is available for the Chrome browser, wherein the history and cookies for the websites you browse aren't recorded.

These are just some of the major features of CyanogenMod; there are many more miscellaneous tweaks and features that we haven't even talked about. Obviously, the best way to learn more about them is to try them out on your phone! Only then will you come to know whether you like them or not. There are many more options available like MIUI, DarkyROM, etc, which are definitely worth a try.

After you're done with this, you may even consider building a custom ROM for yourself. Though you might easily be able to make a few light modifications before redistributing it, if you are serious about making heavier changes, it definitely takes more than just changing the default theme and bundled software. It needs a lot of reading and guidance from other experienced developers. You could try teaming up with and helping out other developers in their projects, and slowly get acquainted with the community. First though, head over to the forums at [xda-developers.com](http://forum.xda-developers.com), read what others have posted and start asking questions in areas that you find yourself lagging behind. 

Links

- [1] <http://forum.xda-developers.com/>
- [2] <http://wiki.cyanogenmod.com/>

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The author has a crush on Java, and also loves flirting with almost everything related to databases, cloud computing and Web technologies. Feel free to poke fun at this article, and direct your feedback to ankitreloaded@gmail.co

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